

Michael Senko

PhD Student in Linguistics

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Broad: variation, change, sociophonetics, gender

Narrow: reduction, information-theoretic approaches, sociolinguistic cognition, speech production, social meaning

EDUCATION

2025-	Ph.D. in Linguistics	STANFORD UNIVERSITY
	Advisors: Dan Jurafsky, Rob Podesva, Meghan Sumner	
2021-2022	M.A. in Linguistics	NORTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY
	Thesis: Transgressing the binary: Gendered language practices on Twitter.	
	Advisor: Rob Voigt Reader: Annette D'Onofrio	
2018-2022	B.S. in Linguistics and Communication Studies	NORTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY
	<i>summa cum laude</i> , with Departmental Distinction	

PUBLICATIONS

JOURNAL ARTICLES

1. D'Onofrio, A. & **Senko, M.** (2026). Demarcating place authenticity in the CHICAGO vowel. *Language and Society*, 1-28.

PEER-REVIEWED BOOK CHAPTERS

2. **Senko, M.** & Voigt, R. (2025). Transgressing the binary: A computational approach to gendered reference. In S. Burnett & F. Vigo (Eds.), *Battlefield Linguistics*. (pp. 401-426). De Gruyter Mouton.

PRESENTATIONS

REFEREED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

1. **Senko, M.** (2026). A panel analysis of Downeast English reveals disparate gender trajectories in apparent time. Paper presented at *American Dialect Society Research Incubator 1*. 19-20 September, remote.
2. **Senko, M.**, Brown, G., de la Fuente, A., Ikedo, T., Martín Rodríguez, L., Tan, Y. L., WuWong, J., & Podesva, R. J. (2026). Sexual identity, lexical association, and the ideological marking of place in San Francisco. Paper presented at *Lavender Languages and Linguistics 32*. 2-4 September, Edinburgh, United Kingdom.
3. D'Onofrio, A. & **Senko, M.** (2022). "If you say /ʃəkəgʊʊ/, get the fuck out of my face": Variable discourses of localized authenticity in the Chicago vowel. Paper presented at *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 50*. 13-15 October, San Jose, CA.
4. **Senko, M.** & Voigt, R. (2022). Transgressing the binary: Gendered language practices on Twitter. Paper presented at *Lavender Languages and Linguistics 28*. 23-25 May, Catania, Italy.

HONORS AND FELLOWSHIPS

2025-	EDGE Doctoral Fellowship	STANFORD VPGE
2022-2023	Taiwan English Teaching Assistantship	THE FULBRIGHT PROGRAM
2022	Conference Travel Grant	NORTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY
2022	Lambda Pi Eta	NORTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY
2021	Abraham Demoz Prize in Linguistics	NORTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY
2018	Kaplan Humanities Scholar	NORTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY

SKILLS

Languages **English** *Mother tongue* · **Mandarin** *Proficient* · **Taiwanese** *Beginner*
Technical **Advanced:** ELAN · Praat **Intermediate:** R · Python · Java · L^AT_EX

TEACHING

2024-2025	Upper School Computer Science Teacher	COLLEGIATE SCHOOL
2023-2024	Content Teacher	WINSTON PREPARATORY SCHOOL NEW YORK
2022-2023	Teacher of English as a Foreign Language	FULBRIGHT TAIWAN

SERVICE

2026-	Sociolunch Organizer	STANFORD LINGUISTICS
2026	Open House Committee	STANFORD LINGUISTICS
2025-2026	Social Committee	STANFORD LINGUISTICS